ENGLISH

Objectives of Teaching English at the Secondary Level

Students are expected to

- listen to English with proper attention and understanding
- listen to announcements, instructions, read-aloud texts, audio, videos for information, gist and details, and respond to questions accordingly
- speak simple English correctly
- speak on contemporary issues like social justice, environment, gender, etc.
- read English texts and comprehend them
- read stories and literary texts, both fiction and non-fiction, with understanding for pleasure and enjoyment and discuss them
- understand and respond appropriately to what they hear, read and experience
- use subject, or contexts, and content related vocabulary to express their understanding of the texts and tasks.
- interpret different texts including poems, prose, short stories, newspapers, news reports, essays, etc.
- develop an awareness of the nature of language and language-learning skills along with a more general application (e.g., interfacing, analysing, synthesising material)
- enjoy and appreciate variety of language
- appreciate different shades of literary nuances and devices such as onomatopoeic sounds, symbols, similes,metaphors, alliteration, imagery, personification, allusions and the writer's point of view
- write simple and short paragraphs, narratives, etc. by planning revising, editing, rewriting and finalizing
- write reports of functions related to school, family and community
- write personal, official and business letters, articles, debates, paragraphs based on visual or verbal clues, textual inputs, etc.
- evaluate and analyze content in print form such as texts, newspapers, magazines, blogs, etc.
- promote core values such as tolerance, appreciation of diversity and civic responsibility through debate, discussion, etc.
- refer to dictionary, thesaurus, periodicals, and books for understanding and writing purposes and uses them in speech writing
- form a sound base for the skills required to communicate in English
- develop ability to use English effectively for practical communication in a variety of second language situations

Skills

- Listening
- Speaking
- Reading
- Writing

Listening

While listening students should be able to

- comprehend discourse such as lectures, conversations, interviews, and discussions
- make notes and use them in answering questions about the passage
- distinguish relevant from irrelevant information
- identify the topic and the main idea in it
- comprehend relationships between ideas
- make inferences about spoken discourse

Speaking

Speaking should enable students to

- produce appropriate vocabulary
- day-to-day conversation in English
- produce accurate grammatical forms
- give an oral presentation in class using effective delivery strategies.
- present facts, ideas or opinions in an orderly sequence.
- make relevant comments on what is heard, seen or read
- describe experience in simple and express intelligibly what is thought or imagined
- respond appropriately in a particular situation.
- speak audibly with appropriate tone, intonation and pace
- develop adequate speaking skills to communicate effectively to get engaged in meaningful conversations

Reading / Writing: Only a few tasks shall be set to test the reading skill. The skills of reading and writing shall be tested in an integrated manner to reflect the way in which language is actually used. This is to allow writing tasks to be stimulated by authentic reading texts rather than seeing the two activities as diverse elements. However, a few tasks may be set to test the reading skill exclusively.

Reading

Reading should enable students to

- scan for and extract specific information from different texts (at least from the prescribed textbooks)
- organise the relevant information and present it in a logical manner/ given format
- identify the main idea(s) in the text
- identify specific details
- discern main idea(s) from given information

- distinguish fact from opinion
- draw inferences based on information in the text
- decode meanings of words in context
- understand meanings of unfamiliar words
- identify author's purpose and tone

Writing

The skill of writing should enable students to

- write in a simple way
- learn to use words economically
- write sentences with simplicity and clarity
- organise ideas and write short and coherent paragraphs
- write texts, such as writing an essay, short letters, outline of short stories, paragraphs, reports, articles, speech, etc.
- paraphrase and summarise in an appropriate form in response to a written- stimulus
- use words in their proper contexts
- use appropriate vocabulary
- use a variety of accurate sentence structures;
- use accurate grammatical structures

Assessment in Listening and Speaking SkillsGuidelines for

Internal Assessment **20 Marks**

Apart from the prescribed textbook, the subject teachers can plan their own activities and create their own material for assessing the listening and speaking skills.

- Language learning projects / activities should not be confined to classroom teaching only but should enable the students to engage with real life situations. The format and the variety of activitiesshould be extensive.
- The internal assessment based on different activities should be evaluated by the teacher throughout the academic session. It may be preserved for three months after the declaration of results for checking by the Board

Suggested Activities

The suggested activities aim to improve the communication skills and personality of the students. These should be followed by individual, peer and group talk.

- Screening of relevant and age appropriate audio-videos of stories/documentaries/ discussions/ films
- Listening to phone calls
- Model Reading by teacher
- Storytelling
- Narrating incidents
- Interviews
- Group Discussions and Talk Shows
- Role plays
- Debates / Presentations
- Convening meetings/talks in informal situations such as going to the shopkeeper, describing real time events like festivals and matches, picnics, vacations and travelogue

Assessment

Learner assessment is a continuous process and an integral part of teaching learning. The purpose of internal assessment also is that the children learn to handle examination scare and stress. The assessment should be competency-based, promoting higher-order thinking skills, such as analysis, critical thinking, conceptual clarity.
The teachers should use different assessment strategies that connect teaching, learning and assessment to real life settings to assess and provide feedback on activities, surveys, demonstrations, role plays, project works. assignments, presentations, innovations etc. in such a way that the learner doesn't feel that his/her performance is being evaluated. Please refer to the structure of assessment given in the preliminary pages.

Parameters for Assessment

Interactive competence (initiation, turn taking, relevance to the topic)
Use and delivery of words and expressions (coherence and speed of delivery)
Vocabulary and Grammar (clarity, simplicity and precision)
Pronunciation (accent, fluency)

Contents

Prose

1. Footprints without Feet	H. G. Wells
2. An Excellent Father	Jane Austen
3. From the Diary of a Young Girl	Anne Frank
4. Long Walk To Freedom	Nelson Mandela
5. The Sermon at Benares	Berta Renstaw
6. Pappachi's Moth	Arundhati Roy
7. The Merchant of Venice	Adapted and abridged from Charles Lamb's 'Tales from Shakespeare'

Poetry

8. Prayer	G. A. Mehjoor Translated by Prof. G.R Malik
9. Miracles	Walt Whitman
10. When You Are Old	W. B. Yeats
11. Snowdrop	Ted Hughes
12. My Mother at Sixty-six	Kamala Das
13. An Evening Wet with Rain	Ved Pal Deep Translated by Shivnath
14. The Tale of Custard the Dragon	Ogden Nash
15. Last lesson of the Afternoon	D.H.Lawrence

Short Stories

16. The Necklace	Guy de Maupassant
17. Abhiley	Abdul Gani Sheikh Translated by Ravina Aggarval
18. The Servant	S.T. Semyonov
19. Dusk	Saki

Play

20. The Proposal	Anton Chekov
Glossary	

Scheme of Assessment for Class X

Theory Paper= 80 Marks

Internal Assessment= 20 Marks

Tulip Series Book X, A Textbook of English for Class X

Section A

Reading Comprehension **15 Marks**

1. One seen stanza from the poems to be attempted followed by MCQs based on comprehension, literary devices, inference, etc. from the prescribed text. 1 x 5 = 5 Marks
2. One unseen passage of about 400 to 500 words to be attempted followed by MCQs, comprehension questions (SA or VSA), providing suitable title to the passage, one-word substitution, vocabulary, inference, analysis, etc 1x 5= 5 Marks
3. One question based on pictures/statistical data/bar graphs/pie charts/ histograms to be attempted followed by MCQs and SA/VSA questions based on inference, analysis, evaluation, etc. 1x5= 5 Marks

Section B

Grammar **10 Marks**

Modals, Articles, Relative Clauses, Tenses, Narration, Punctuation

- One passage with blanks to be filled by using appropriate articles, modals, relative pronouns etc. 3 Marks
- One passage given in direct/indirect speech to be converted inversely. 3 Marks
- One contextualized passage/ story/ paragraph to be edited testing the use of tenses, punctuation, articles, pronouns, spellings etc 4 Marks

Section C

Writing Skills **25 Marks**

- Create/Write dialogues on given situation with the help of hints. 4 Marks
- One question to be attempted on notice writing with the help of hints. (50 words). 3 Marks
- One question to be attempted on message writing with the help of hints (50words). 2 Marks
- One letter to be attempted out of the given two (formal/informal). 5 Marks
- One speech/ article /paragraph to be attempted on a given topic out of two. The hint words will be given. (80 -100 words) 5 marks
- A creative story to be developed out of the given hints and also to suggest a suitable title. 6 marks

Section D

Literature

30 Marks

- Three out of five short competency-based questions to be attempted from the prose lessons of the prescribed textbook. 3x3 = 9 Marks
- Three out of five short competency-based questions based on theme, central idea, literary devices to be attempted from the poems excluding the one given in reading comprehension. 3x3= 9 Marks
- One out of three long answer competency-based questions to be attempted based on character/ scene/ theme/ plot, situation, event, irony etc. from the short stories. 1x6 = 6 Marks
- One out of two long answer competency-based questions to be attempted based on character/ scene/ theme/ plot, situation, event, irony etc. from the play. 1x6 = 6 Marks

Note:-

The question paper will contain questions based on critical and creativity thinking (*HOTS) to discourage rote memory.

***HOTS - Higher Order Thinking Skills**

- The students must read the textbook thoroughly for comprehensive and better understanding of the topics.
- The examiner will not ask very short questions from a poem in Literature Section if the poem or the extract has been asked in the Reading Comprehension.
- The examiner will not ask short type questions in Literature Section from a chapter if the seen passage from the prescribed textbook has been asked in Reading Comprehension.

Internal Assessment

20 Marks

Assessment of LSRW (Listening, Speaking, Reading, and Writing) Skills will be for 20 marks. Practice and assessment are to be based on the activities included in the prescribed textbooks and by taking recourse to various resources and techniques available in the school. The guidelines to evaluate the listening and speaking skills have been given in the objectives of teaching English at secondary level.

Schedule

- The practice of listening and speaking skills should be done throughout the academic year.
- The final assessment of the skills is to be done as per the convenience and schedule of the school.

Suggested Reading in Grammar

For grammar, teachers and students can refer to any standard grammar textbook for further reading and clarification of concepts. Some of the books include:

- A Practical English Grammar by Thomson and Martinet (Oxford University Press)
- High School English Grammar by Wren and Martin (S Chand Publishing)
- English Grammar in Use by Raymond Murphy (Cambridge University Press)